

00 · Project Context & Mandate

Organizational Context

I worked within the enterprise IT function of a higher-education organization that wanted to explore how AI could support day-to-day operations and automate workflows. There was no established AI infrastructure for the workflows in scope, so the work began with identifying useful opportunities rather than implementing a predetermined solution.

The starting question was: **Where could automation meaningfully improve the team’s work, and what would be required to make it reliable and usable?**

My Role and Team

I was embedded in a scrum team alongside an **enterprise architect, business analyst, scrum master, and operations analyst**.

My mandate was to connect business discovery with hands-on delivery: understand how team members worked, identify and prioritize automation opportunities, develop selected workflows, evaluate their performance, and support adoption through documentation and enablement.

The initial focus was the team’s workflows, with the broader aim of establishing practices that could support further AI adoption.

Scope of the Mandate

Area	Responsibility
Business discovery	Understand stakeholder responsibilities, goals, recurring activities, handoffs, and pain points.
Opportunity assessment	Identify worthwhile automation opportunities and prioritize them by business value, feasibility, effort, and risk.
Requirements and solution design	Define workflow requirements and success criteria. Determine whether conventional automation, AI assistance, or an agentic approach fits the problem.
Implementation and evaluation	Build selected workflows, test their behavior, and establish appropriate quality checks, guardrails, and human-review checkpoints.
Adoption and ongoing operation	Develop playbooks and user guidance, support rollout, and define how performance, cost, failures, and feedback should be monitored.

Delivery Approach

Understand the work → **Prioritize opportunities** → **Define requirements** → **Build and evaluate** → **Support adoption** → **Monitor and improve**

The approach started with stakeholder conversations and workflow understanding. Technology selection followed problem definition, with decisions guided by business value, quality, cost, risk, and maintainability.



Intended Outcome

The goal was not to introduce AI into every task. It was to deliver useful automation where justified and establish the supporting documentation, evaluation practices, and team guidance needed to operate it responsibly.

Success meant more than a working prototype: it meant a workflow the team could understand, trust, use, and maintain.